

early, I must pay a price - either put in higher amounts, or settle for a lower corpus and often a lower return.

The numbers added up to astonishing levels and the combinations were crazy. For example, you could contribute for 30 years of retirement with 10% of your salary invested consecutively for 15 years now. Historically, people did retirement funding with last-gap measures and lived off pensions. And I had this new-fangled concept flashing across me, ticking off several dreams and possibilities. At this moment, several trains of thought led to one conclusive decision: I decided to hop on this journey and swing for the fences.

As I learnt more, I realized the practical world never works like the uniform rise as depicted in the graphs but with deep valleys and long plateaus. It is filled with people: their emotions splattered on financial press, dreams run amok, opinions vomited with little introspection, personal propaganda promoted, professions derided and a noise-filled sanctuary where clear thoughts are at a premium. Staying sane, not listening and making contributions every month was made more difficult by the increasing hypocrisy of information accumulation. It felt like I had to cross this river of immaturity to remain sane for the rest of my life. To help you cross this river much easier than I did, Week 5 will cover step-by-step best practices with clear action plan pointers.

This leads us into the final solution

3) Consistency in financial decisions

When Facebook eulogized the term, *'Done is better than perfect'*, they intended to move fast and break things. TripAdvisor also thrived on similar la-vie for their growth. Drawing yet another business analogy: Jeff Bezos often tells the public that any innovation has a two-year head-start before the market starts to replicate, duplicate and improve the product. But with Amazon Web Services and so many other Amazon ideas, they had a period of 5-7-year head-start *'luckily'*. Luck had a little role but their two-year work entailed so much advancement that any behemoth found it worthless to try and compete against. Amazon was the seven-hundred-pound gorilla rolling down the hill because of the momentum it gained over the first two